THE DIARY OF A CEO

× OMKAR MARENNAVAR

AN ORIGINAL COMPANION E¯BOOK / EPISODE 232





How to Seduce *Anyone*

ATTENTION / CONFIDENCE / REAL CONNECTION

WRITTEN BY

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2026 / FIRST EDITION

How to Seduce Anyone

A simple guide to attention, confidence & real connection.

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SOURCE CONVERSATION

Robert Greene with Steven Bartlett on The Diary Of A CEO, Episode 232 (23 March 2023).

The explanations, scripts, exercises and design in this book are original. This is a companion guide, not a transcript, and Robert Greene is not credited as its author.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A better meaning of seduction

The title is bold. The truth is simple.

You cannot make anyone like you. The person in front of you has a full life, a choice, and the right to say no. No line, look, or trick can change that.

In a conversation on The Diary Of A CEO, author Robert Greene talks about attention, effort, openness, confidence, and the way we relate to other people. This short guide turns those themes into everyday actions.

Here, seduction means making room for mutual interest. It starts when you are present enough to see the other person clearly, and honest enough to let them see you.

> KEEP THIS
>
> You can invite. You cannot force.

For respectful connections between adults. Interest and consent must move both ways.

YOUR ROUTE THROUGH THE BOOK

Contents

01	Turn your attention outward	06
02	Make them feel seen	08
03	Confidence is evidence	10
04	Effort beats performance	13
05	Be open, not dramatic	15
06	Notice cues. Ask clearly.	17
07	Keep it light. Keep it honest.	20
08	Build a life that holds you	22
—	The seven-day practice	24
—	Connection check-in	26
—	Ten lines worth keeping	27
—	Source & episode guide	29

PART ONE

01 Presence

Attraction starts when attention leaves the mirror and meets a real person.

NOTICE / LISTEN / REMEMBER

CHAPTER 01 / PRESENCE

Turn your attention outward

The first move is not a move. It is attention.

A new conversation can fill your head with noise: How do I look? What should I say? Do they like me? When you spend all your energy watching yourself, you miss the person in front of you.

Try a small shift. Ask one question you truly want answered. Listen to the whole reply. Notice the part they sound excited about, then ask about that part. Let their answer guide the next minute.

This is not a way to collect someone's weak spots. It is a way to meet them as a person, rather than as a test you need to pass.

KEEP THIS

Before you try to impress, learn one true thing.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

The 60-second listening reset

When you feel nervous, you do not need a clever line. Give yourself one minute to listen well.

01 **Pause**

Let them finish. You do not need to fill every quiet second.

02 **Pick up a detail**

Choose one thing they care about, not the most impressive thing you can say.

03 **Ask one more**

Use a short follow-up: “What was that like for you?”

IN A REAL CONVERSATION

“I started learning to cook.”
“Nice. What made you want to start?”

One good follow-up is worth more than five prepared questions.

CHAPTER 02 / ATTENTION

Make them feel seen

People notice when you notice them.

Being seen does not mean being praised all night. It means someone remembers what matters to you. Maybe they remember the exam you were worried about, the music you love, or the way you like your coffee.

Use details with care. A thoughtful question next week can mean more than a big compliment today. But do not act as if attention gives you a claim on someone's time or affection.

Give attention freely. Then give the other person room to choose whether to come closer.

> KEEP THIS
>
> Attention is a gift, not a bargain.

A BETTER CONVERSATION

Questions that go somewhere

Start with a simple question. When a topic opens up, follow it. You are looking for a story, not an interview.

01
Instead of “What do you do?”
Try: “What part of your day gives you energy?”

02
Instead of “Do you like travel?”
Try: “What place has stayed with you?”

03
Instead of “How was work?”
Try: “What was the most interesting part?”

04
Instead of “What music?”
Try: “What song do you always return to?”

KEEP THIS

Ask. Listen. Share something real in return.

CHAPTER 03 / CONFIDENCE

Confidence is evidence

Real confidence grows from what you do.

You can act fearless for a few minutes, but a performance is tiring. Quiet confidence is different. It comes from keeping promises to yourself, learning a skill, and handling small hard things.

Choose one thing you want to get better at. Practise it a little each week. Let yourself be a beginner. Every small piece of progress gives your mind a real reason to trust you.

Your worth is not a score based on how many people date you. Confidence also means knowing you will be okay when someone is not interested.

KEEP THIS

Build a life you respect; do not build a mask.

ONE-MINUTE EXERCISE

A small confidence ledger

At the end of the day, write three short lines. Do it even on days when nothing dramatic happened.

I DID SOMETHING DIFFICULT

I LEARNED SOMETHING USEFUL

NEXT TIME I WILL TRY

Example: “I started a conversation even though I felt shy.” Progress counts before any outcome.

PART TWO

02

Mutual interest

A good connection is not won. It is chosen, one honest moment at a time.

EFFORT / OPENNESS / CONSENT

CHAPTER 04 / THOUGHTFULNESS

Effort beats performance

Thought matters more than money.

A date feels better when someone has considered the other person. A good place can be a quiet café, a free art show, or a walk in a busy public park. The point is care, not expense.

Think about comfort. Is the plan easy to reach? Is there time to talk? Does it fit what they said they enjoy? Give them a real choice rather than a surprise they cannot easily refuse.

Make an effort with your own basics too: be on time, be clean, and be kind to the people around you. These actions speak more clearly than a perfect line.

KEEP THIS

A thoughtful plan says: I paid attention.

WORDS YOU CAN USE

The simple invitation

A clear invitation is easier to answer than a vague hint. Keep it light and make “no” safe.

A THOUGHTFUL ASK

“I’ve enjoyed talking with you. Would you like to get coffee this weekend? There’s a quiet place near the park. No pressure if not.”

01 **Make it specific**
Offer a place or activity, plus a simple time.

02 **Make it comfortable**
Pick a public setting and ask what works for them.

03 **Make it optional**
If they decline, thank them and leave it there.

A simple plan made with care is enough. You do not need to spend beyond your means.

CHAPTER 05 / VULNERABILITY

Be open, not dramatic

Honesty makes space for closeness.

In the episode, Greene draws a line between vulnerability and being trapped in your own worries. Vulnerability lets another person see a little of the real you. It does not ask them to rescue you.

You can say you feel nervous. You can share a hope, a small fear, or something you care about. Then listen to how the other person responds. Closeness grows at a pace both people can choose.

You do not owe a new person your deepest story. They do not owe you theirs. Being open also includes having boundaries.

KEEP THIS

Share a truth. Leave room for theirs.

WORDS YOU CAN USE

Three honest sentences

You can be direct without making a big speech. Choose words that feel like yours.

01 **Name a feeling**
"I'm a little nervous, but I'm glad we met."

02 **Name an interest**
"I like talking with you. I'd like to see you again."

03 **Name a boundary**
"I'd rather take this slowly."

Do not use a painful story to rush intimacy or ask for a promise.

KEEP THIS

> Honesty is simple when it has no hidden demand.

CHAPTER 06 / CLARITY

Notice cues. Ask clearly.

Body language is context, not proof.

A person may lean in because they are interested, because the room is loud, or because they cannot hear. One gesture cannot tell you what they want. Even a warm smile is not permission for touch.

Look at the whole moment: are they replying with ease, asking you things too, and choosing to stay? If you are unsure, ask. Spoken answers matter more than your guess about a signal.

01 If they seem engaged

Keep talking and leave room for their choice.

02 If they seem unsure

Slow down. Ask what they would prefer.

03 If they pull away or say no

Stop. Respect the answer without debate.

THE MOST IMPORTANT PAGE

A “no” is an answer

You may ask once with care. You may not turn someone’s “no” into a problem for them to solve. Silence, uncertainty, and a past “yes” are not a new “yes.”

IF THEY DECLINE A DATE

“Thanks for being clear. I wish you well.”

IF YOU WANT TO CHECK ABOUT TOUCH

“Can I hold your hand?” If the answer is not a clear yes, do not do it.

A kind response to rejection protects both people’s dignity. It also shows that your interest was never a demand.

KEEP THIS

Clarity is better than pressure.

PART THREE

03

Keep it real

The most attractive life is not built around getting an answer from one person.

PLAY / GROW / LET GO

CHAPTER 07 / PLAYFULNESS

Keep it light. Keep it honest.

Playfulness invites. Games confuse.

A little humour can help two people relax. Laugh about the world together. Be curious. Let a moment be imperfect. Playfulness is shared; it does not put one person on trial.

Do not pretend to be busy so they chase you. Do not try to make them jealous. Do not hide your interest to gain an advantage. Those moves can create tension, but they do not build trust.

01 **Warm**
Offer a real smile or a kind observation.

02 **Specific**
Bring up something the two of you actually share.

03 **Free**
Let the other person be interested, unsure, or not interested.

A SIMPLE CONVERSATION MAP

From hello to invitation

01 **Open**

Notice the shared moment. “Have you been to this event before?”

02 **Listen**

Follow one detail from their answer.

03 **Share**

Offer a little of your own story. Do not make them do all the work.

04 **Invite**

If the interest feels mutual, make a simple, clear ask.

A NATURAL ENDING

“I’ve liked talking with you. Would you want to continue over coffee sometime?”

If the answer is no, a warm goodbye is a complete ending.

CHAPTER 08 / GROWTH

Build a life that holds you

The strongest foundation sits outside the date.

Greene connects real confidence with doing things, not just talking about them. Learn a craft. Show up for friends. Care for your body and your time. Make choices you can respect even when nobody is watching.

A full life does not make you immune to disappointment. It does give you somewhere steady to stand when a conversation does not turn into more.

You do not have to become a perfect person before you can date. Begin where you are. Grow because your life is yours, not because someone needs to reward you for it.

KEEP THIS

Be someone you enjoy being with, too.

FOUR SMALL HABITS

A quiet weekly routine

Try these habits for four weeks. Keep them small enough to repeat.

01 **Learn**
Spend 30 minutes getting better at one useful or joyful skill.

02 **Connect**
Call a friend or make time for someone you already care about.

03 **Notice**
Have one phone-free conversation and ask a real follow-up.

04 **Recover**
Rest, move, or do one thing that makes your week easier.

KEEP THIS

> Consistency is quieter than charisma—and more useful.

DAYS 01—03 / START SMALL

The seven-day connection practice

This is a practice, not a test. Do it with friends, new people, or someone you are dating. Keep every step respectful.

01

Pay attention

Put your phone away for one conversation. Notice what the other person cares about.

02

Ask again

Use one gentle follow-up instead of changing the subject to yourself.

03

Build evidence

Do one small thing you have been avoiding. Write down what you learned.

At night: write one sentence about what felt easier than expected.

DAYS 04—07 / MAKE IT REAL

Keep going, keep choosing

04 **Be a little open**
Share one honest thought. Keep it small and true.

05 **Show care**
Remember a detail and ask about it. Expect nothing in return.

06 **Invite clearly**
If you want to see someone, ask once and give them a comfortable way to say no.

07 **Reflect kindly**
What did you learn about them? What did you learn about yourself?

KEEP THIS

> The goal is not a yes. The goal is a more grounded you.

SAVE THIS PAGE

A one-page connection check-in

Before a date or a new conversation, take a breath. Afterwards, write a few honest words.

BEFORE / WHAT AM I CURIOUS TO LEARN?

DURING / DID I LISTEN AND SHARE?

AFTER / DID I FEEL SAFE AND RESPECTED?

NEXT / WHAT WOULD I CHOOSE?

THE HIGHLIGHT REEL

Ten lines worth keeping

01	See a person, not a prize.
02	Ask what you want to know.
03	Listen for the part that matters to them.
04	Make care specific; expect nothing back.
05	Build confidence through real action.
06	Share truth at a human pace.
07	Treat body language as a clue, never consent.
08	Make invitations clear and easy to decline.
09	Let “no” remain a complete answer.
10	Keep building a life that is yours.

ONE LAST THOUGHT

The final page

You do not need to become someone else.

You can be a little nervous and still be warm. You can be new at dating and still make a thoughtful plan. You can hear “no” and still hold on to your dignity.

The practice is simple: turn outward, pay attention, tell the truth, and give the other person room to choose. Do this often enough and your conversations become less about winning and more about understanding.

> KEEP THIS
>
> Connection works best when both people are free.

Written by Omkar Marennavar. Inspired by a conversation with Robert Greene on The Diary Of A CEO.

FURTHER READING & LISTENING

Source & episode guide

The book is an original interpretation of themes from this conversation:

Robert Greene: How To Seduce Anyone, Build Confidence & Become Powerful | E232
youtube.com/watch?v=Qv70RMUFlu0

WATCH THE RELEVANT MOMENTS

42:10	Seduction and attention
45:24	What works against connection
51:18	Thought and effort in dating
59:19	Confidence built through action
1:02:48	Nonverbal communication
1:11:26	Mastery and learning

Editorial note: The conversation is the source of the themes. The consent guidance, scripts, questions, writing exercises and seven-day plan were written for this guide. No interview transcript is reproduced.

Written by Omkar Marennavar. First edition, October 2026.